

P2: Fire and Ice

By Robert Frost

Message

The poem conveys that uncontrolled emotions like desire (fire) and hatred (ice) can lead to destruction, whether on a personal or global scale. It teaches us to maintain balance and control over our emotions to prevent harm and ensure harmony in life.

Mood

It is contemplative and thought-provoking. The tone is calm yet intense, encouraging readers to think deeply about the consequences of their actions and feelings.

Justification of the title

The title 'Fire and Ice' is highly appropriate as it directly reflects the central theme of the poem. The poet uses fire and ice as symbols for two powerful human emotions- desire and hatred- that can lead to destruction.

Theme

- Destructive power of emotions
- Balance and control
- Duality of human nature
- Inevitability of destruction

Poetic devices

Alliteration

- Some say
- Favour fire

Metaphor

- Fire and ice

Symbolism

- Fire and ice

Antithesis

It is a poetic device in which two opposite or contrasting ideas are placed together in a sentence or line to highlight the contrast.

- Fire and ice

Imagery

- The world will end in fire
- To say that for destruction ice is also great
- Fire → heat, burning destruction
- Ice → cold, freezing stillness

Anaphora

- Some say

Enjambment

Paradox

It is a statement that seems contradictory or impossible at first, but actually contains a deeper truth.

- Both fire (desire) and ice (hatred) can destroy the world despite being opposite.

Assonance

- I hold with those who favour fire

Practice Questions:

1. Discuss the role of emotions in *Fire and Ice* and mood transformation in *Dust of Snow*.
2. How does irony in Lencho's story differ from the subtle transformation in *Dust of Snow*? Explain with examples.